Unicorn Season is a one-page setting developed with **Breathless** about a blessing of unicorns that must survive hunters who want to kill them for the healing powers of their horns.

Everything was peace and quiet...

All was peace and quiet in the forest until the king fell very ill and the royal physician determined that the only cure was a unicorn's horn.

Soon, professional unicorn hunters appeared, along with people seeking the gold reward offered for your horns.

It's Unicorn Season!

Creating Your Unicorn

When creating your unicorn, you must choose its name, pronouns, and coat color. Then, you must distribute a d10, a d8, and a d6 among the six skills (Gallop, Bite, Kick, Neigh, Instincts, and Mythology). The remaining skills each receive a d4.

Skills

The 6 skills are:

Gallop: It's used for running, jumping, and dodging. It's also used for ramming or dragging an opponent.

Bite: It is useful for tasks that require precision, such as manipulating a small object, untying a knot by biting, or removing a door lock without making noise.

Kick: Besides being a way to attack your enemies, it also allows you to hit large objects hard and, for example, knock down doors, overturn tables, or open barrels.

Neigh: Neighing is your way of communicating with and manipulating humans. You can try to attract and seduce maidens and youths, intimidate peasants into giving you food, and frighten hunters into fleeing in terror.

Instincts: Determine your ability to survive in the forest, orient yourself, find water and food, follow tracks and hide your own, hide from your enemies or plan ambushes against them.

Mythology: You are a mythological being and have extensive knowledge of mythology. You know things like how you can only be stopped with golden ropes or how you can be lured into a trap using virgin maidens and youths, etc. You also have knowledge of other magical forest beings like elves and gnomes.

When there's a challenge to overcome, you roll to see how it plays out. **You only need to roll if what you want to do is risky.**

The GM announces that your action could be risky and dangerous; then you choose a skill and roll the die corresponding to your score.

Check Result

1-2	You fail, and there's an additional complication.
3-4	You succeed, but there's a complication.
5+	You succeed. The higher the result, the better the effect.

Being a unicorn hunted for its healing horn is difficult, so **each roll reduces the score of the skill used** by one level to a minimum of d4.

Fatigue

When you fail as a result of one of your actions, the GM may decide that you receive 1 level of fatigue. If your character reaches 4 levels of fatigue, you are exhausted.

When exhausted, failing a dangerous action means falling into the clutches of a hunter or mercenary, or being mortally wounded.

You can consume a **rainbow apple, to remove 2 points of fatigue**. Alternatively, you can hide in a **safe place** for a while to **remove 1 point of fatigue**.

Magic Horn

In dangerous or complicated situations, you can attempt to **use your magic horn** and make a **d12 roll** instead of a roll using your current skill rank.

Once you have used your magic horn, **you cannot use it** again until you **rest in a crystal clear water stream**.

Crystal clear water streams

Everyone knows that unicorns love to drink from crystal-clear streams and rest to the soothing sound of their waters.

Resting and drinking from a crystal-clear stream allows the unicorn blessing to take a short break to calm down, assess the situation, and look for a way to escape their pursuers or face the dangers ahead.

To find and drink from a stream, you must be out of danger **in a quiet place, far from the sight of hunters**. At such times, you can search for a pristine stream.

If the herd rests in one of these places, **it recovers all lost skill dice levels and restores the magic of its horn**.

Equipment

You can carry no more than **three objects: one on your rump, one in your snout, and one attached to your horn**. These can be used in place of your abilities. They start with one die level, which decreases after each use. When the value is reduced to a d4, the object breaks, is lost, or simply disappears from the story.

Objects on your rump must be of a suitable shape to prevent them from falling. You can carry a blanket or ropes, even a human body, but not a cup or a tray, as these will fall at the slightest touch. Objects on your horns and in your mouth cannot be too large.

Carrying an object in your mouth means you cannot **Bite**, and carrying one attached to your horn means you cannot use its **Magic**.

You can **drop them and use Bite or Magic**, but the objects will be damaged and **lose one die level**.

Forage

When the situation allows, you can forage to find items from the faerie inhabitants, herbs with magical properties, rainbow apples, and so on. Be careful, though, because you might encounter things you didn't intend to, such as a group of mercenaries.

To forage, **roll a d12** and consult the table below.

d12	Forage
1-2	Trouble is here...
3-4	There's trouble ahead...
5-6	Add a d6 item
7-8	Add a d8 item
9-10	Add a d10 item or a rainbow apple
11-12	Add a d12 item or a rainbow apple

If you are unsure what you get with the forage roll, you can roll a d10 on the following table.

d10	Item
1	Aconite Leaves
2	Gnome Tools
3	Will-o'-the-Wisp
4	Hunter's Trap
5	Mandrake Root
6	Fairy Runestone
7	Belladonna Leaves
8	Four-Leaf Clover
9	Goblin weapons
10	Fairy Dust

Hunters

Humans have been hunting you ever since the king fell very ill, which is why encountering one of them is potentially dangerous.

Some will be brutal and bloodthirsty with their bows and swords, others cunning and treacherous with their traps and poisons; none will ever come with good intentions. You can trust neither the virginal lads nor the chaste maidens.

Humans and unicorns cannot communicate. Humans don't understand the neighs of unicorns, and unicorns don't understand human words.

The Forest

The forest where you live is a magical place inhabited by other magical creatures: gnomes, goblins, fairies, and more. They can either help you or get you into even more trouble than you already have.

Fairies: Capricious and fickle, they only care about having fun. They might offer invaluable help or simply ignore you and laugh and dance while you struggle to survive.

Only try interacting with them as a last resort, because it usually doesn't go well for you.

Gnomes: Hardworking and steadfast, they are always busy doing all sorts of things in the forest, from storing food for winter to tending to injured animals or searching for healing herbs for their poultices. You can trust them and ask for their help, but don't push your requests too far, or they will disappear, and you will never find them again.

It is important that you repay any favors they have done for you.

Goblins: Greed for the king's reward gold has turned them against you, and they are looking for ways to hunt you down and sell you to the highest bidder. They are not strong, but there are many of them, and they are usually good at setting traps.

Be careful if there are goblins nearby.

Wargs: Perhaps the only natural predators unicorns have. These large wolves are intelligent and hunt in packs, and when they find your blood trail, they will relentlessly pursue and devour you.

You'll have to use your best tricks to outwit them and avoid their ambushes.

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THIS GAME IS
BREATHLESS